

AUTOBIOGRAPHY



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Introduction

My name is **Grace Ndumbi**, and this is the story of my journey, a story shaped by faith, family, and a deep desire to grow into the person God created me to be. Writing this autobiography is both a reflection and a reminder of how far I have come, the lessons I have learned, and the dreams I continue to pursue.

I was born and raised in Kenya, in a home where faith and hard work were the foundations of daily life. From a young age, I was taught that success is not measured only by what we achieve, but by the honesty, humility, and kindness we show along the way. These values have guided me through every season of my life, from childhood curiosity to the responsibilities of adulthood.

Looking back, my life has been a mix of small beginnings, challenges that tested me, and moments of grace that shaped my outlook on the world. I have learned that each stage, whether easy or difficult, has a purpose. My faith has been my anchor, reminding me that every challenge is a chance to grow and every blessing is a reason to be grateful.

Today, as a **BBIT student**, I see my journey not just as a personal story but as a testimony of persistence and faith in God's timing. I have come to believe that growth happens step by step, in both the quiet moments of reflection and the active pursuit of dreams.

My goal in life is to become an innovative and reliable professional in the field of information technology, someone who uses knowledge to make a real difference in people's lives. Beyond career ambitions, I aim to live a life guided by integrity, compassion, and service. This autobiography is my way of appreciating where I have been, understanding who I am now, and preparing for who I am becoming.

Family Background

I come from a loving and hardworking family that has shaped the person I am today. My parents have always been my greatest role models, teaching me the importance of honesty, hard work, perseverance, and faith. From them, I learned that every challenge in life is an opportunity to grow and that success is built on dedication, patience, and integrity.

My father is a farmer, a man who leads by example and values hard work. I have always admired his determination and commitment to providing for our family, even during difficult times. If one could ask me who the hardest-working man I know is, I would say my dad because he has sacrificed a lot for us as a family. He is a tea and dairy farmer, and as you know, that alone cannot sustain our needs, so he has always been involved in other businesses. I always remember the moments we shared as a family having dinner together, and our dad would share stories to motivate us.

My mother is also a farmer, a caring and supportive woman whose warmth and guidance have made our home a place of love and learning. She is usually engaged in farm business like poultry farming, fruit and vegetable farming. I recall mornings when she would wake me up with a cheerful voice, helping me get ready for school. Her patience and gentle insistence on good manners and discipline instilled in me a sense of respect for others and a love for learning.

Growing up, I also had the joy of being surrounded by three siblings, two sisters and one brother, each of whom has taught me different lessons. My siblings and I share laughter, challenges, and memories that have strengthened our bond over the years. I must say it's quite difficult relating to them, considering the age difference, but we have always managed.

Starting as a firstborn is my sister, whom I love very much and who has supported me all the way since I can remember. The age difference between us is twelve years, so I feel she is more experienced and knowledgeable in many areas. I remember when I was young, and she was in college, I used to admire her so much to a point that I started dressing, talking, and doing things the way she did. I loved how clean she was, how respectful and kind she was. She is a laboratory technician and devotes herself to that field so she can help others. She has instilled so much in me, and I am glad to say I still have a lot to learn from her.

Second-born is our only brother, whom we love so much. Growing up around him was such a blessing. I was small, but he was such a big brother to me in all aspects. The age difference is ten years, but that didn't stop us from having the best memories growing up. Although I remember him from high school, we created so many memories, especially on weekends, that sometimes I just want to go back in time and relive the memories. He is an executive driver, and he works hard to provide for his family. He has a son, whom we love so much. My brother has always taught me to be kind to all and to always follow my dreams.

Third-born is my sister, and I love her so much. This one I can remember going to primary school together and all the memories we created. She was such a big sister to me and ensured I was comfortable at school. I remember when I couldn't make friends in my class, I used to go to her class during break time, and I would spend the time with her classmates, which was really fun. The age difference is eight years, but when growing up, I didn't feel much of the difference. She is the funniest in our family, which makes spending time with her more enjoyable. She is a farmer and works really hard to provide for her family. She has two sons, and I love them so much. The fact that they stay at home and make their grandparents happy makes me relieved knowing they have people to help them out and keep them company, so they don't get stressed.

Family traditions have always been important to us. Every holiday, we gather for meals, prayer, and storytelling. I especially treasure the times when we would sit together after dinner, sharing dreams, fears, and lessons from our daily lives. Faith plays a central role in our household; prayer and reflection guide our decisions and remind us of the importance of gratitude, humility, and integrity. These traditions have shaped my character and given me a sense of belonging and purpose.

The home I grew up in was not just a physical space, but a place where values were nurtured, dreams were encouraged, and character was built. I learned that love is shown in small acts of care, that hard work is often quiet but impactful, and that faith is the foundation for facing life's uncertainties with courage and hope. These lessons continue to guide me as I navigate the world, reminding me of who I am and where I come from.

Childhood memories

The many memories I have about my childhood are mostly happy, and I am glad I was brought up in such a loving and supportive family.

I was raised in a God-fearing family that has always shown me to trust, obey, and have faith in God. Growing up, I joined Sunday school, before joining nursery, and I learnt a lot from songs, bible verses, and others. As I grew up, I became invested in the church. I used to lead while presenting songs on Sundays, and I loved it. I remember us going for church competitions and that would require us doing so much practice on songs, poems, the statement of faith, and prepping for bible questions. Those were such unforgettable moments that contributed to shaping who I am today.

Growing up with my sister was fun; we were each allocated work that we would do after school, and we made sure we did it. Some of my chores included fetching water, washing utensils, and putting on my school uniform. I used to love playing with my sister, and it was so fun. One thing about my parents is that they wouldn't allow us to loiter around the neighborhood for no reason, so we spent our time at home helping out where we could. Some of the tasks we used to help included picking tea, planting in the garden, digging, getting Nappier grass, and others. However, our parents made sure we did only what we were capable of and that we left ample time for studying.

One thing that I remember well from primary school is how we used to carry lunch from home. The fact that my mom is a farmer really helped, but at the same time, we got kind of tired of eating pumpkins so much. She loved planting pumpkins, potatoes, arrowroots, sweet potatoes, bananas, peas, beans, maize, and others. For the most part, we used to cook githeri, potatoes, arrowroots, pumpkins, and bananas, which is not bad, but the fact that you are supposed to eat that the following day at school for lunch when the food is cold, and it's a cold season, that was bad. I really do thank God because we never get sick because of that. Looking back now, when we sit as a family, we laugh about it, and it just reminds us how Mom would ensure we don't lack.

Some of the best memories are from Christmas, when each of us would get a new dress, sweater, and shoes, and we would wear them on Christmas Day. We used to celebrate the day as a family

by cooking together, sharing meals, and taking pictures. That would be one of the few times I would see my other older sister and brother, and I enjoyed spending time with them.

With time, my sister finished school, and she left for college, and I was left alone in class five. My grandmother, who was our neighbor, was living alone, so I went to live with her. I will always cherish the moments we shared. I used to come back from school, leave some of the books at home, carry the ones with homework to my grandmother's place, and the uniform so I could wash it. She would get me a cup of tea and something to eat, then I would go to my room, start teaching and doing homework until it's dark. From then, I light the lamp and do my reading while she cooks dinner. We would enjoy supper as she shares many beautiful stories about the old times, and I would be very happy listening. She used to go to sleep early, and after I finished my work, I got to sleep also. My dad had bought me an alarm that I would set to wake up. The previous night, I would put bathing water in a thermos, tea for breakfast in another thermos, and bread in a dish. When I woke up in the morning, I would shower, put my uniform on, eat breakfast, and then wait for either my mom or dad to come get me. They would knock on my window when they arrive so I finished preparing as they milked grandmother's cow.

I would go home with them, get the rest of my books, and lunch that my mom used to pack in a dish and leave for school, and the cycle would repeat day after day. Sometimes I would cook mandazis at night with grandma and bring them to my classmates at school.

I remember how we used to play with my cousins whenever we got the time, and it was so fun. My grandmother had a chicken shed, but there were no chickens. We used to play acting as if it were our house. I liked acting like a mother, where I did almost everything my mom did. On Sundays after church, we would act as if we were in a church, and we would do everything that was done at church. The oldest of us all used to act as the driver every time we would get in an upper cube of the chicken shed, which was very small, and he would drive. Sometimes I feel sad that we grew and we don't see each other often.

I always count my childhood as a blessing because, despite having some challenges, we learned from them and they shaped us.

Primary school life

In the year 2009, at the age of four years, I joined nursery school. I was brought up in the village, so there were no baby classes; a child would just get into nursery, then class one up to class eight. I remember I was so young and so happy to join school.

My teacher was Teacher Mary, whom I remember to this day, as she helped shape who I am today. I loved school, and I enjoyed making friends. One of the memories I have from nursery is coming back from school, where I would take off my uniform, wash it, but only the light ones, and the dishes. I would then get my food and tea, pretend to be Teacher Mary, and start teaching the chairs. I would write on the wall with charcoal as I was teaching, and I would enjoy it so much. My dad noticed it, and he bought me a small blackboard, white chalks, and a duster. I was so happy because now I was so much like my teacher, and I enjoyed doing it. My parents were also happy because they knew once I got home, I wouldn't be a bother to them, and they could actually work without the fear that I'm misbehaving.

My performance in nursery school was good, and my parents made sure to show me how proud they were of me. The following year, 2010, I was supposed to join primary school, but the teachers in primary school said I was too small. However, after checking my performance, they agreed for me to join class one, and I was very happy to join my sister's school.

Finally, I got to join the big school, yet I was so tiny, one of the things that got me through class one is that I was a clever student. My class one teacher was Mrs. Njihia, and I loved her so much. Later, after term one, she was transferred, and we got another teacher. I don't actually remember her name. I got to make new friends, play a lot, and teach empty chairs and fences after school.

After joining class two, Mrs. Njihia came back, and I was very happy. Right about the second term is when I realized I loved mathematics; it was my favorite subject. The school was public, and we used to be taught in Kikuyu, talk about learning English and Swahili in Kikuyu. We also did Kikuyu as a language subject from class one to three.

When I said I loved mathematics, that didn't come so naturally, but I'm glad it came the way it did. So our teacher used to give homework, go and learn multiplication of each number a day from 0 to 10, I used the cover of a book which usually had. I also had to learn late at night, and since I was sleepy, I got used to putting my legs in cold water in a basin. The following day, the teacher

would just pick a random student, ask a question from the homework, and if you got it right, you got a sweet; if you didn't, you took off your shoes and socks and would be beaten with a cane. That wasn't very fun at the beginning, but with time, everyone got motivated to try their best since kids love sweets.

From classes one to three, that is, the lower classes, things weren't as bad. Joining the upper classes in class 4, I was very happy because I could start using an ink pen. In lower classes, we only use pencils, but when you join the upper class, you are expected to lessen your mistakes and are allowed to use pens. Things started getting serious, and I got lots of assignments that I could do while teaching the chairs.

The rest of the year went on well. I was a class prefect in class 5 for one term, then I realized it was so hard leading those students. In primary school, we didn't pay much in school fees, only 600 shillings per year for the teachers employed by parents, and 30 shillings when doing an exam.

Within the blink of an eye, we were in class eight, preparing for the KCPE. I was scared of what would happen, but I'm glad everything went well. We got to select schools of choice before the exam, we scrubbed our desks, and we had to do our exam in October 2017.

I couldn't believe I just completed primary school. I was still so small. The only thing left was to wait for the results and hope I could get into a good school.

High School Life

I remember every detail of the day the KSPE results were out. I had gone to visit my grandmother, and I heard it on the radio. I got the code and sent my student exam number. The results were not much of what I expected, but I'm glad I passed. I called my parents, and they were very happy. After a while, I got accepted to Githuguri Girls' High School, and I was very happy about it.

My sister brought the admission document I filled out and got the shopping list. My dad didn't wait for long; he asked me to prepare so we could go shopping at Thika. I got all I needed, and when I returned home, it hit me really hard that I'm about to join high school.

January 9th 2018, is the day I reported. I went with mom, dad, brother, and my sister. It was so confusing to see all these people, and the school was big, considering where I previously was. I got admitted, and I had to say goodbye to my family. My mother had the fear that I would not stop crying, but to my surprise, after they left, I cried for a little bit, then made peace with it.

I got to make two new friends, and I was so happy about it. The first week, we didn't do much reading; we were just familiarized with the school rules and how everything works. I got admitted to 1South and Usambara dorm. One thing about the school is that they named their dormitories after mountains, so we had Mt. Usambara, Mt. Longonot, Mt. Aberdare, Mt. Kenya, and others I can't quite remember.

The school program was a huge change for me, but luckily, I adapted quickly. We were required to settle for morning preps from 5 am to 6 am, have breakfast, and do our allocated duty from 6 am to 6.45 am, come back for preps up to 7.45 am, have a meeting or school parade up to 8. From there we could start our classes up to 4:10 pm, during which a tea break was at 10, lunch at 12.30 p.m. After 4.30 p.m. on Monday and Wednesday, we would have remedial classes, on Tuesday and Thursday, we would have games, and on Friday, we would have CU & CA services. We had supper from 5.45 pm to 6.30p.m then head for night preps until 9.30 p.m. We were given 30 minutes, then the lights went out at 10 p.m.

The duties allocated included cleaning classrooms, verandahs, dormitories, dining hall, wash rooms, tidying up the environment and others. I got used to the program, and it became easy though not every day. The program above was for weekdays; on Saturday and Sunday, we used to wake up at 6am. On Saturday, we would do general cleaning up to 8, then have lessons up to 1 p.m. After

that, the dormitories were opened, so we were free. On Sunday, we had a service at 8 a.m. where we used to go outside to ACK Church, come back by 10.30a.m have tea, and be free for the rest of the day.

High school was fun on most days. I enjoyed learning new things, but still had a problem with the sciences. I remember the first term, midterm, how I carried everything so my mother could label them. I got tired, but it was worth it. The end of the first term is one moment I remember very well. My dad came to pick me up, and after he learned of my good performance, he asked what I wanted as a reward, and I jokingly said a phone. To my surprise, my dad called my brother, and he helped us purchase a new phone. I was far beyond excited.

First year as a form one went on well, and before we knew it, we had even finished form two. My performance was good, so I joined form three in January 2022. This is the year that everyone in the world remembers well. Before we could finish our first term, the deadly coronavirus pandemic hit, and we had to go home. It was very sad because we were never told when to go back, and then hearing about the death rates was so traumatizing. We stayed home the rest of the year with the curfews and hoped for the best.

During that time, our teachers used the numbers we had given out to ask parents to join WhatsApp groups. The teachers were sending past papers, notes, tutorials, and assignments there; of course, not all students were able to access them, but to those who did, it was helpful. Going back to school after almost a year's break wasn't easy. We had almost forgotten everything, and we needed a fresh start, but time was not on our side. We still had the restrictions; we couldn't spend more time in a room, but the teachers managed, and before we knew it, we joined form 4.

Despite the fact that we managed, there were still challenges, and we as students had to keep re-learning. After we returned, I vied to be the assistant dorm prefect, and I was elected. I never thought it would be that hard. The hate from some students for doing your job changed everything about me. I shut down, and I didn't want much interaction. My classmates then started saying some very bad things about me, thinking that shutting down was bad; my self-esteem dropped, and I was just surviving.

When I joined from four, I didn't vie to be the dorm's captain; I decided to concentrate on myself since I noticed a drop in my academics. I spent more time with God, alone, going for walks in the

evening around the school field, and that really made an impact, and I started seeing things from a different perspective.

I still did not want much interaction with my classmates, but it felt nice to know more about myself, seeing improvements in my academics. I remember after an exam being called out as the best improved student in form four, which made me very happy. From then on, some started befriending me, asking for academic help. I helped them, but I didn't want close connections because I knew what it had cost me.

I focused on studies, and before we knew it, it was weeks to KCSE. The school allowed parents for a day before the exam, and I was very happy when I saw my sister. We spent the day talking, and I enjoyed the time we spent together. I also called my parents and other siblings, and was very happy.

From then it was serious business, final preparations for the final exam. I was so scared at first, but after doing my first paper, I realized it was just a normal exam. I prepared well and hoped for the best.

March 31st was when I finished my last paper, and I could not wait to leave that place. Yes, it shaped me, but at the same time, there were very dark moments that I wouldn't wish anyone to go through. Seeing my mom waiting for me made me so emotional, I ran to her and was very happy closing that chapter of my life. We took some pictures and headed home.

When I got home, everyone was there, they were very happy for me, and one thing I will always remember and be glad for is finding a newborn baby, my nephew. He was like a reward for my work, and he healed me in ways I could never imagine.

University Life

Around June 2022, the KSCE results were out, we were seated as a family having lunch, then I got a message from school to send my number to the given code. I was shaking so much, but I gathered all my strength and did as required. When I heard the notification, I thought my heart stopped for a bit, but then, after looking at the results, I got so emotional that I couldn't even tell others what made me cry, so I went out relaxed and then came back with the good news. Everyone was so happy for me, and it was such a relief for me to know that chapter is completely closed.

A while after, I got a message from my sister, she helped me select the universities of choice and my course, and we waited. Then one day, I got a screenshot from her, a congratulations from Dedan Kimathi University of Technology. Indeed, God has been kind and good to me. That was the beginning of a new chapter. My dad made sure I got everything I needed from the phone, laptop, and all other things.

One thing I love about my dad is how good a planner he is. Around July, he went all the way to Nyeri to look for a hostel where I could stay, and he actually did. When he came back, he had a contact of the roommate I was going to stay with. Her name was Grace, just like mine, and I enjoyed talking to her over the phone and learning more about campus. However, I had so many expectations that when she told me each person in the room has their own bed, chair, table, and wardrobe, I interpreted it as a two-bedroom house with sofa sets, until I came and when the door opened, I saw the whole house.

I reported on 4th September 2022, with my sister accompanying me, we spent the night there, and she left the following day. Something happened when I was pushing her. I got a call from my roommate that I should go remove my belongings since the matron has allocated the space to someone else. I didn't want my sister to worry, so I just brushed it off. When I came back to the house, I found all my things displaced. We went to consult the matron, and the attitude she gave was unprofessional.

After two days, the other lady came. The matron told me to remove my things so she could settle. I just did that and left, talked to my sister because I had already paid the house earlier, and communicated with the assistant matron because she wasn't available. Long story short, we had to share the room for a month, and it wasn't a good beginning.

The orientation at the university went well, although I got lost, but Grace helped me figure it out. Our first will always be memorable. I didn't know the venue, and everyone I asked also didn't know. That is when I spotted this small girl like me who was just as lost as I was, we talked and I learnt she was pursuing the same course as I, her name was Sharon. We exchanged numbers in case one finds the venue to call the other. We finally found the class, and that is how I met my best friend.

First year wasn't that bad, but I had a lot to learn, I had to adapt, and I did, which I'm glad. The person I have interacted with the most is Sharon. We have shared tough seasons, good and better seasons, we have grown together, and I am happy I found her as a friend.

I loved how university life was, that no one cares, you have to care for yourself, I learnt to say no where necessary, I learned to make decisions wisely. I also learnt to commit to my studies; there was no one to force me or punish me if I didn't, but I had to decide on a better future.

It's surprising how time flew away first, because before I knew it, we were in year two, semester three, doing our internal attachment. I learned a lot during that period. After the semester, we had a month's holiday, and I was very happy to spend that time with my family. The rest of the holidays we usually have two weeks, but then, since I had a whole month, I was looking forward to unforgettable moments with my family.

Yes, the moments were unforgettable, but they sure were not good memories. I arrived home on Monday, and everyone was okay, then on Tuesday evening, I got the bad news that my dad's brother had passed away. That really broke my heart, but we had to gather the courage. From Wednesday that week to Friday the next week, there was no resting, especially for my mom. My dad's brother was our neighbor, so my mum and aunt were busy with all the preparations. We laid our uncle on Wednesday, and we were left doing much work. On Friday, everything was done, and I remember mom saying how she was glad that she would have a good night of rest. We were relieved of the heavy work and were left mourning.

The following day, on Saturday, dad and his other brother had taken my grandmother to the hospital for a check-up. At around noon, we received a call from Dad that shattered every hope we had; Grandma had passed away. It had been a few days after laying our uncle to rest, and now she was gone too. She was well known, and the number of people that came was huge that means a lot of

work. From that day to the day she was laid to rest on Saturday the following week, we were so busy and tired that there wasn't time to grieve. We grieved after everyone was gone. The pain of losing two family members in a span of 2 weeks is huge. That is how I spent my holiday, I wasn't prepared to go back to school, but I had to, so I went to join the third year.

Things went on well for the first semester, we came back for the second, and that is when the lectures went on strike, and we were forced to do our exams in January 2025. That season taught me to be patient and appreciate what I have.

After our exams, we had our industrial attachment. I started looking for options in November 2024, but we didn't have the insurance and school letters yet, so I couldn't apply. After we got them, most of the positions were filled, so I applied online, which I had no hope. Before starting our exams, I decided to go to Nyeri town and look for the options I hadn't looked for. I went from office to office; some were full, some sent me to other offices that sent me back to them, and I was very tired.

After the last office, I decided to go home as I was too tired to walk. I sat down below a tree to recharge, and that is when I got a call from KEMRI, that I was accepted and had to go pick up my acceptance letter. I was so excited that I got into a hotel that I know very well, not in the comrade's price range but I just needed to feel happy and relaxed.

I called my sister, shared the good news, and was ready for that chapter. I can confidently say that God has carried me, He has loved, cared, and blessed me in ways I cannot even comprehend. I will always be grateful. My attachment period was good, and I am so glad I got that opportunity despite the challenges I faced during that period. I learned so much, and I will forever be grateful.

Coming back after that meant the last year of campus, and I was looking forward to it. The first semester went on well, but then the second semester went on strike again, and so we will have to do our exams in January 2026.

Skills Development

My journey in skills development has been one of gradual discovery, curiosity, and continuous growth. Over the years, I have developed both technical and personal skills that have shaped my academic path and future career goals. These skills did not come all at once; they were built step by step through school, practice, challenges, and the willingness to keep learning even when things felt difficult.

My interest in computers began at a young age, when I first encountered a computer during my school years. At that time, technology felt both fascinating and intimidating. I was curious about how machines could store information, display images, and perform tasks so quickly. What started as simple curiosity slowly grew into a genuine passion. I began paying closer attention during computer lessons and spent extra time practicing whenever I had the opportunity. That early exposure laid the foundation for the technical path I am pursuing today.

One of the first areas where I built confidence was in **basic computer packages**. I learned how to use Microsoft Word to type, format, and edit documents. At first, it was challenging to understand how formatting tools worked, but with practice, I became comfortable creating well-structured documents. This skill has been extremely important in my academic journey, as it allows me to prepare assignments, reports, and projects clearly and professionally.

I also developed skills in **Microsoft Excel**, where I learned how to enter data, use formulas, and create simple charts. Excel taught me the importance of accuracy and organization when working with information. Over time, I began to understand how spreadsheets could be used not only for schoolwork but also in business and real-life problem-solving. This skill strengthened my analytical thinking and attention to detail.

Another important tool I mastered is **Microsoft PowerPoint**. Through creating presentations for class assignments and projects, I learned how to communicate ideas visually and effectively. I discovered that good presentations are not just about putting text on slides, but about organizing information in a way that is clear, engaging, and easy to understand. This skill has helped me become more confident when speaking in front of others and sharing my ideas.

As my confidence in basic computer packages grew, my interest expanded into the deeper world of **Information Technology**. Joining the BBIT program marked a major turning point in my

skills development journey. University studies exposed me to new concepts such as programming, databases, systems analysis, and networking. These areas challenged me to think logically and approach problems in a structured way.

Learning **programming languages** was one of the most challenging yet rewarding parts of my academic journey. At first, coding felt like learning a completely new language. I had to understand how small instructions could be combined to create full programs that perform specific tasks. Through patience and practice, I gradually developed skills in writing and understanding code. Programming taught me problem-solving, persistence, and the importance of paying attention to detail, because even a small mistake can cause an entire program to fail.

In addition to programming, I also gained skills in **database management**. I learned how data is stored, organized, and retrieved using database systems. Understanding databases opened my eyes to how information systems work behind the scenes in organizations such as banks, schools, and hospitals. I practiced creating tables, entering records, and running queries to retrieve information. This experience helped me appreciate the importance of data accuracy, security, and proper organization.

Networking is another area that contributed to my technical growth. Through my studies and certifications, such as **Cisco**, I learned the basics of how computers communicate over networks. I gained knowledge about IP addresses, network devices, and how information travels from one point to another. These skills helped me understand the infrastructure that supports modern communication and internet services. Earning a certification in this area boosted my confidence and showed me that with dedication, I can master complex technical concepts.

Beyond technical knowledge, my skills development journey has also strengthened my **soft skills**. For example, working on academic projects has improved my teamwork and communication skills. Group assignments required me to share ideas, listen to others, and sometimes take leadership roles to ensure tasks were completed on time. These experiences taught me responsibility, cooperation, and the importance of respecting different perspectives.

Time management is another skill I have developed over the years. Balancing coursework, personal responsibilities, and skill-building activities has not always been easy. However, I

learned to plan my time carefully, set priorities, and stay disciplined. This skill has helped me meet deadlines and reduce stress, especially during busy academic periods.

Problem-solving is perhaps the most valuable skill I have gained. Whether fixing a computer issue, debugging a program, or handling a challenging assignment, I have learned to approach problems calmly and logically. Instead of giving up when something does not work, I now try different solutions, research, and ask for help when necessary. This mindset has increased my confidence and resilience.

Creativity has also played a role in my skills development. Designing presentations, working on projects, and exploring new technologies have allowed me to think creatively about how to solve problems and present ideas. I have learned that technology is not only about technical knowledge but also about innovation and imagination.

Overall, my skills development journey reflects my belief in continuous learning. Technology is always evolving, and I understand that to remain relevant, I must keep improving my knowledge and abilities. Every new skill I acquire brings me one step closer to my goal of becoming a competent and innovative IT professional. I am proud of how far I have come, from being curious about computers to actively building technical solutions and understanding complex systems.

These skills are not only shaping my career path but also preparing me to make a meaningful contribution to society. I hope to use my knowledge to solve real-world problems, support businesses and communities, and inspire others—especially young people—to pursue careers in technology. My journey in skills development is still ongoing, and I am excited about the many opportunities to learn, grow, and achieve more in the future.

Work Experience

My work experience has played a major role in shaping both my professional skills and my personal growth. Through hands-on roles in the technology field, I have been able to apply what I learned in class to real-life situations, interact with different kinds of people, and better understand the responsibilities that come with working in the IT industry. Two key experiences that stand out in my journey are working as a **cyber attendant** and completing my **industrial attachment at KEMRI in the IT Department**.

One of my earliest professional experiences was working as a **cyber attendant**. This role gave me my first opportunity to operate in a real technology service environment and interact directly with clients. My main responsibilities included assisting customers with computer use, printing and scanning documents, typing and editing work, and offering basic technical support. At first, I was nervous about handling customer requests on my own, but with time, I grew more confident and capable.

Working at the cyber taught me the importance of **patience and communication**. Many customers were not familiar with computers, so I had to guide them step by step on how to open files, browse the internet, or send emails. I learned how to explain technical processes in a simple and respectful way. This experience improved my ability to communicate clearly and professionally with people from different backgrounds and age groups.

I was also responsible for **document preparation**, including typing letters, CVs, school assignments, and business documents for clients. This strengthened my speed and accuracy in using Microsoft Word and improved my attention to detail. I had to ensure documents were well formatted, free of errors, and ready for printing. Handling these tasks daily made me more efficient and confident in producing professional-quality work.

Another important part of my cyber attendant role was managing **printing, photocopying, and scanning services**. While these tasks may seem simple, they require careful handling of customer documents, proper organization of files, and time management—especially during busy hours. I learned how to multitask, prioritize urgent tasks, and remain calm under pressure. These skills have been very helpful in my academic life and other professional settings.

In addition, I sometimes helped troubleshoot **basic technical issues**, such as slow computers, printer errors, or internet connectivity problems. Even though these were small technical challenges, they gave me practical exposure to problem-solving in a real environment. I learned to observe issues carefully, try possible solutions, and seek help when necessary. This built my confidence in handling technical tasks independently.

Beyond technical abilities, working as a cyber attendant taught me **responsibility and professionalism**. I had to report on time, handle money carefully, treat customers with respect, and maintain a clean and organized workspace. This experience helped me understand workplace discipline and the importance of being reliable and trustworthy.

Another significant milestone in my professional journey was my **industrial attachment at the Kenya Medical Research Institute (KEMRI) in the IT Department**. This experience exposed me to a more structured and professional working environment within a large and respected organization. Being attached to KEMRI allowed me to see how information technology supports research, healthcare systems, and organizational operations.

During my attachment, I assisted the IT team with various technical tasks. One of my key roles was helping with **computer maintenance and troubleshooting**. I observed and supported technicians as they diagnosed hardware and software problems, installed operating systems, and configured applications. This experience gave me practical insight into how IT professionals maintain systems to ensure smooth operations in an organization.

I also gained exposure to **network support**. Although I was still learning, I observed how network connections were managed and how issues such as connectivity failures were handled. I learned about the importance of network security, proper configuration of devices, and the role of IT in ensuring that staff can communicate and access systems without interruptions.

Another area where I gained valuable experience was **user support**. Staff members often reported IT-related issues, and I assisted in recording problems, offering basic solutions, or directing them to the appropriate technician. This role strengthened my communication and customer service skills in a professional environment. I learned how to listen carefully, ask the right questions, and respond respectfully to users who might be frustrated by technical problems.

At KEMRI, I also observed the importance of **data security and confidentiality**. Because the organization handles sensitive research and health-related information, strict rules were followed regarding system access and data handling. This experience taught me the ethical responsibilities that come with working in IT, especially in institutions that deal with critical and private information.

Working in a professional IT department helped me develop **workplace confidence and teamwork skills**. I interacted with experienced IT professionals, asked questions, and learned from their guidance. Being part of a team showed me how collaboration is essential in solving technical problems and completing projects efficiently.

Both my experience as a cyber attendant and my industrial attachment at KEMRI have greatly influenced my career goals. The cyber job taught me how technology serves everyday people, while KEMRI showed me how IT supports large institutions and critical services. Together, these experiences helped me see the wide range of opportunities within the IT field and strengthened my desire to grow as a technology professional.

These work experiences also helped me connect theory to practice. Concepts I learned in class—such as computer hardware, networking basics, software installation, and customer support—became more meaningful when I applied them in real situations. I now feel more prepared for the professional world because I understand both the technical and human sides of working in IT.

Overall, my work experience has shaped me into a more skilled, confident, and responsible individual. It has taught me the value of professionalism, teamwork, communication, and continuous learning. As I move forward in my career, I carry these lessons with me, knowing that every experience—big or small—contributes to my growth and prepares me for greater responsibilities in the future.

Personal Qualities

Beyond academic knowledge and technical skills, my personal qualities and hobbies have played a major role in shaping who I am today. These traits influence how I relate with others, handle responsibilities, and approach challenges in both my personal and academic life. I believe that character is just as important as skill, because it determines how effectively a person uses their abilities to make a positive impact.

One of my strongest personal qualities is **responsibility**. From a young age, I learned the importance of being dependable and taking my duties seriously. Whether it is completing assignments on time, helping at home, or fulfilling workplace tasks, I always try to give my best effort. I understand that responsibility builds trust, and trust is essential in both personal relationships and professional environments. This quality has helped me stay disciplined in my studies and manage my time effectively.

I also consider myself to be a **hardworking and determined** person. Throughout my education, I have faced situations that required extra effort and perseverance. There have been moments when academic work felt overwhelming, especially when balancing multiple subjects or learning difficult technical concepts. Instead of giving up, I learned to stay patient, seek help when necessary, and keep trying until I understood. This determination has strengthened my confidence and taught me that growth often comes through persistence.

Another important quality I possess is **honesty and integrity**. I value doing the right thing even when no one is watching. In school, this means completing my work honestly and respecting academic rules. In the workplace, it means being trustworthy when handling tasks, information, or responsibilities. Integrity has become one of the guiding principles in my life, shaping how I make decisions and interact with others.

I am also a **good team player**. Through group projects in school and collaboration during my work experiences, I have learned how to work with different personalities and perspectives. I listen to others, share my ideas respectfully, and contribute actively to group tasks. Teamwork has taught me patience, communication, and compromise. I understand that great results often come from collective effort rather than individual work alone.

Closely related to teamwork is my ability to **communicate effectively**. While I may not always be the loudest person in the room, I express my thoughts clearly and respectfully when needed. Working as a cyber attendant and during my attachment helped me improve my communication skills, especially when explaining technical matters to people who may not have a background in technology. I have learned to adjust my communication style depending on who I am speaking to, which is an important life and professional skill.

Time management is another quality I have developed over the years. Balancing school, work responsibilities, personal life, and self-improvement has taught me how to plan my time wisely. I make schedules, set priorities, and avoid procrastination as much as possible. This skill has reduced stress in my life and helped me meet deadlines consistently.

In addition, I am naturally **curious and eager to learn**. I enjoy discovering new ideas, skills, and information that can help me grow. This curiosity is one of the reasons I am drawn to the field of Information Technology, which is constantly evolving. I believe that a willingness to learn is one of the most valuable qualities a person can have, because it opens doors to endless opportunities.

Apart from my personal qualities, my **hobbies** also play an important role in my life. One of my favorite hobbies is **exploring technology and learning new digital skills**. I enjoy practicing computer skills, trying out new software, and understanding how different technologies work. Sometimes I watch tutorials or read articles to expand my knowledge beyond what I learn in class. This hobby not only interests me but also supports my academic and career goals.

I also enjoy **reading inspirational and educational materials**. Reading helps me relax while also expanding my knowledge and perspective. I am especially inspired by stories of people who overcame challenges to achieve their goals. Such stories motivate me to remain focused and hopeful even during difficult times.

Another hobby I value is **spending time with family and close friends**. These moments help me relax, laugh, and recharge emotionally. Whether we are having conversations, sharing meals, or simply spending time together, these interactions remind me of the importance of relationships and support systems in life.

I also enjoy **quiet moments of reflection and prayer**. My faith is an important part of who I am, and taking time to reflect helps me stay grounded and grateful. It gives me strength during challenges and reminds me to approach life with humility and hope.

In many ways, my hobbies balance my academic and professional life. While my studies and career goals require focus and discipline, my hobbies provide relaxation, inspiration, and personal growth. Together, my personal qualities and hobbies shape me into a well-rounded individual who values learning, relationships, faith, and self-improvement.

As I continue to grow, I hope to strengthen these qualities and develop new ones that will help me succeed in life. I believe that success is not only about professional achievement but also about becoming a person of good character who positively influences others. My personal qualities and hobbies are an essential part of that journey.

Challenges and Lessons

Like every life journey, mine has not been without challenges. While I am grateful for the many opportunities I have had, there have also been moments that tested my strength, patience, and faith. These challenges, though difficult at the time, have shaped my character and taught me lessons that continue to guide me today.

One of the main challenges I have faced is **academic pressure**. Pursuing a course in the field of Information Technology requires dedication, focus, and the ability to understand complex concepts. There were times when coursework felt overwhelming, especially when balancing multiple units, assignments, and deadlines at the same time. Some technical subjects were particularly challenging and required extra time and effort to understand. During such moments, I sometimes doubted myself and wondered whether I was capable of succeeding.

However, these experiences taught me the value of **perseverance**. Instead of giving up, I learned to seek help from classmates, lecturers, and online resources. I developed the habit of studying consistently and breaking large tasks into smaller, manageable parts. Over time, I realized that challenges often appear bigger than they truly are, and with patience and effort, they can be overcome.

Another challenge I have faced is **financial limitations**, which at times made it difficult to access certain resources or meet educational expenses comfortably. This situation required me to become more responsible and careful with how I managed money. I learned the importance of budgeting, prioritizing essential needs, and appreciating even small opportunities. These experiences taught me humility and gratitude, reminding me not to take anything for granted.

I have also experienced moments of **self-doubt and fear of failure**, especially when trying something new or stepping out of my comfort zone. For example, learning programming for the first time felt intimidating, and I often worried about making mistakes. However, I eventually understood that mistakes are part of learning. Each error became a lesson, and each difficulty helped me grow stronger and more confident.

Through these challenges, my **faith** has been a constant source of strength. During stressful times, prayer and reflection helped me find peace and hope. My faith reminded me that challenges are temporary and that every struggle has a purpose. It gave me the courage to keep moving forward even when the path seemed uncertain.

These experiences have taught me several important lessons. First, I have learned that **resilience is built through difficulties**, not comfort. Every challenge I overcame made me stronger and more prepared for future obstacles. Second, I have learned the importance of **asking for help**. There is strength in seeking support and learning from others. Finally, I have learned to **believe in myself**, even when situations seem hard. Confidence grows when we face challenges instead of avoiding them.

Today, I see my past struggles not as setbacks, but as stepping stones that have shaped me into a more patient, determined, and hopeful person. The lessons I have learned continue to guide me in my academic journey and personal life, and they give me confidence that I can overcome whatever challenges the future may bring.

Future Goals

As I reflect on my journey so far, I also look ahead with hope, determination, and a clear sense of direction. My future goals are shaped by my experiences, my faith, and my desire to grow both professionally and personally. I believe that life is a continuous journey of learning, improvement, and service to others.

Professionally, my main goal is to build a successful career in the field of **Information Technology**. I aspire to become a skilled and innovative IT professional who can use technology to solve real-world problems. With the rapid growth of digital transformation, I want to be part of the generation that creates systems and solutions that improve lives, enhance businesses, and support communities.

I am particularly interested in areas such as **software development, systems support, and emerging technologies**. I plan to continue improving my technical skills by learning new programming languages, gaining professional certifications, and staying updated with technological trends. I understand that technology is constantly evolving, and I am committed to being a lifelong learner so that I can remain relevant and effective in my career.

In the future, I also hope to work in an organization where I can grow professionally while contributing positively to society. Whether in the private sector, public institutions, or research environments, I want to be known as someone reliable, hardworking, and solutions-oriented. I would like my work to make a meaningful difference, especially in areas where technology can improve efficiency, access to information, and service delivery.

Beyond my career, I also have important **personal goals**. I aim to grow into a person of strong character, guided by faith, integrity, and compassion. I want to build a life that reflects my values—one where success is not only measured by achievements but also by the positive impact I have on others.

Family is very important to me, and one of my long-term goals is to build a stable and loving family of my own while continuing to support and appreciate the one I come from. I hope to create a home environment built on respect, faith, understanding, and encouragement, just as I experienced while growing up.

I also want to give back to society in any way I can. In the future, I would love to mentor young people, especially those interested in technology, and encourage them to pursue their dreams despite challenges. I believe that sharing knowledge and experiences can inspire others and create opportunities for growth in the community.

Another personal goal is to continue growing spiritually and emotionally. My faith plays a central role in my life, and I want to strengthen my relationship with God while maintaining a grateful and humble heart. I hope to face future challenges with courage, wisdom, and trust in God's plan for my life.

In the next five to ten years, I see myself as a confident professional working in the IT field, financially stable, continuously learning, and contributing positively to my workplace and society. At the same time, I see myself growing personally—building strong relationships, maintaining good values, and living a balanced and meaningful life.

In conclusion, my future goals are not only about career success but also about becoming a better person each day. I want my journey to be one of purpose, growth, and service. With faith, determination, and hard work, I believe I can achieve these goals and make a positive difference in the world around me.

Conclusion

Writing this autobiography has allowed me to pause and reflect on my journey, where I started, the experiences that shaped me, and the direction I am heading. It has reminded me that life is not only about big achievements, but also about the small steps, quiet lessons, and meaningful relationships that shape who we become.

Looking back, I see a journey marked by growth, learning, and faith. From my childhood years filled with curiosity, to my school life where I built discipline and knowledge, to my university education and work experiences that prepared me for the professional world, each stage has played an important role in shaping my identity. Every challenge strengthened me, every success encouraged me, and every lesson guided me toward becoming a better version of myself.

One thing I have come to understand is that growth does not happen in comfort. The moments that stretched me the most—academically, financially, and emotionally- are the ones that taught

me resilience, patience, and determination. These experiences helped me discover the inner strength I did not know I had. They also reminded me that setbacks are not the end of the journey, but part of the process that prepares us for greater things ahead.

My faith has been a constant foundation throughout my life. In times of uncertainty, it has given me hope. In moments of success, it has reminded me to remain humble and grateful. Faith has taught me to trust that every season of life has a purpose, even when I do not fully understand it at the time. It continues to guide my decisions, shape my values, and give me the courage to face the future.

I have also learned the importance of people in my journey. My family, friends, teachers, and colleagues have all contributed to the person I am today. Their support, encouragement, and guidance have helped me overcome difficulties and celebrate achievements. This reminds me that no one succeeds alone; we are shaped by the love, advice, and influence of those around us.

As I look ahead, I carry with me not only knowledge and skills, but also lessons about character, perseverance, and purpose. I now understand that success is not just about having a good career, but about living a life of integrity, kindness, and service. I want my life to reflect values that uplift others and make a positive difference, no matter how small.

This autobiography is not just a story of my past; it is a foundation for my future. It reminds me of how far I have come and encourages me to keep moving forward with confidence and faith. While I know there will be new challenges ahead, I also know that the experiences I have had so far have prepared me to face them with strength and wisdom.

In the end, my journey is still unfolding. I am still learning, still growing, and still becoming the person I am meant to be. With faith in God, belief in myself, and a willingness to work hard, I am hopeful and excited about what the future holds.